being tried (in October 2011) was similar to that which was tried in Swat, where the government offered a peace deal to the militants in 2009, but launched a military operation after the Taliban refused to honour their end of the bargain.

All the peace deals were negotiated by the Pakistan military, except the Swat Agreement, which was negotiated by the civil government. A review of these peace deals makes one commonality clearly evident that all the agreements were signed to placate adversary from a position of weakness. This appeasement was accentuated in the demands put forward by the government or military in agreements. Resultantly, all the major peace deals collapsed renewing the cycle of violence.

The Pakistan Army entered FATA for the first time on the night of 25 June 2002 on its maiden military adventure in the tribal belt called Operation 'Kazha Punga', named after a remote village in South Waziristan, to hunt weapon caches and kill the Commander Nek Muhammad Wazir-led small group of both local and foreign militants at the behest of Washington. After many Pakistani commandoes were killed, the troops encircled a compound in Kazha Punga after getting intelligence about the presence of Al Qaeda operatives. The ambush was an eye-opener for the Pakistan Army as the 35 Al Qaeda operatives escaped the compound killing ten commandoes. The incident showed that the foreign fighters had entrenched themselves in FATA and enjoyed considerable local support (Hussain, 2010).

In March 2004, the Pakistan Army moved into SW to counter the Afghan Taliban and Pakistani militants, causing a revolt of tribesmen under the tutelage of local mullahs. The military incursion resulted in widespread destruction and fierce fighting, killing hundreds of people including women and children. In some cases, army units refused to fight. As a result, many officers were reportedly dismissed from the army. The sharply deteriorating circumstances forced the government to submit to the first of the several peace agreements with tribal militants. It was struck with Nek Muhammad Wazir-led militants. The deal stipulated the militants to stop targeting Pakistani forces and to cease cross-border attacks in Afghanistan in lieu of amnesty, expulsion of foreign militants and withdrawal of troops. 'Operation Kaloosha' led to the Shakai Agreement with Nek Muhammad in April 2004.